



Shift Note Guide

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This Guide supports Workers at JustUs & Co to complete accurate, timely and NDIS-compliant Shift Notes when delivering supports to Clients. It sets out what information must be recorded, how to write professional and objective notes, and what to do in specific circumstances.

Workers should keep this Guide accessible while entering Shift Notes in ShiftCare to ensure each entry meets the standard expected by JustUs & Co and the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission.

1.2 Why Shift Notes Matter

Shift Notes are not optional — they are a legal and regulatory requirement. Well-written Shift Notes:

- demonstrate to the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission that supports were delivered as planned;
- support each Client's safety, continuity of care and goal progress;
- protect Workers in the event of complaints, incidents or audits;
- enable JustUs & Co to meet its obligations under the NDIS Practice Standards and the NDIS (Provider Registration and Practice Standards) Rules 2018; and
- form part of each Client's official record, which must be retained for a minimum of seven (7) years.

1.3 When to Complete Shift Notes

Shift Notes must be completed immediately upon the conclusion of a shift, or at the latest within one to two (1–2) hours of finishing. Notes completed hours or days after a shift are not considered contemporaneous and do not meet NDIS requirements. Refer to the Staff Compliance and Administrative Obligations Policy for consequences of late or incomplete notes.

1.4 Related Documentation

This Guide should be read alongside the Staff Compliance and Administrative Obligations Policy and all other relevant Policies and Procedures in the JustUs & Co Policy Register.

2. Mandatory Information — Every Shift Note

2.1 Required Fields

Every Shift Note entered in ShiftCare must include the following information. Shift Notes missing any of these fields will not meet JustUs & Co or NDIS compliance standards.

Date	The date the shift was delivered.
Start time	The time the shift commenced.
End time	The time the shift concluded.
Worker name	Your full name as it appears on your employment record.
Client name	The full name of the participant you supported.

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Location	Where the support was delivered (e.g. client's home, community, day program).
Support type	The type of support delivered (e.g. personal care, community access, domestic assistance, high intensity support).
Goals worked on	The specific goal(s) from the Client's Support Plan that the shift supported.
Supports delivered	A clear, factual description of what was done during the shift.
Wellbeing	The Client's mood, engagement, and physical presentation during the shift.
Incidents	Whether any incident, accident, near miss or reportable event occurred. If yes, full detail is required (see Section 5).
Handover	Any information the next worker or team needs to know.

3. How to Write Good Shift Notes

3.1 Be Factual and Objective

Shift Notes must record what you observed and what happened — not your interpretations, assumptions or personal opinions. Write what you saw, heard, or did.

✓ Write like this	✗ Not like this
"John appeared calm and engaged throughout the shift."	"John was in a good mood." (subjective opinion)
"Client ate half of his lunch and declined the remainder."	"Client didn't eat much." (vague, not measurable)
"Sarah stated she was feeling tired today."	"Sarah seemed depressed." (diagnosis/assumption)
"Client required two verbal prompts to initiate personal care."	"Client was difficult with personal care." (judgemental)

3.2 Be Specific and Measurable

Vague notes do not meet NDIS standards. Use specific, measurable language wherever possible.

✓ Write like this	✗ Not like this
"Client walked 200 metres independently using her walker."	"We went for a walk." (how far? independently?)
"Worker assisted client to shower, wash hair and dress."	"Assisted with personal care." (what specifically?)
"Client attended Myer with worker for 45 minutes."	"Went shopping." (where? duration? what for?)

3.3 Write in Third Person

Always refer to yourself as "the worker" or "support worker", and to the Client by their first name or as "the client". Avoid writing "I" or "me".

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✓ Write like this	✗ Not like this
"The worker assisted David to prepare lunch."	"I helped David make lunch."
"Support worker prompted the client to take her medication."	"I reminded her to take her medication."

3.4 Centre the Client's Voice

Where the Client has expressed a preference, choice or opinion, record it using their words (in quotation marks) rather than paraphrasing.

- "Maria stated she would like to go to the park next week instead of the shops."
- "Client said 'I don't want to do that today' and the activity was not pursued."

3.5 Confidentiality

Shift Notes are confidential records. Do not include personal information about people other than the Client (e.g. family members' names, addresses or identifying details) unless it is directly relevant to the support delivered and appropriate to record.

4. Section-by-Section Guide

4.1 Goals and Outcomes

Every shift must be linked to at least one goal from the Client's current NDIS Support Plan. Identify the goal and briefly describe how the shift worked toward it.

What to include:

- The goal title or description from the Support Plan (e.g. "Increase independence in daily living tasks").
- What specifically was done during the shift to work toward that goal.
- Whether any progress was made — and if so, describe it specifically.
- If the goal was not worked on (e.g. client declined), explain why.

Example: "Goal: Increase independence in meal preparation. Worker provided verbal prompts only while David prepared a toasted sandwich independently. David required no physical assistance and expressed satisfaction with the outcome."

4.2 Supports Delivered

Provide a clear, chronological account of the key activities and supports that occurred during the shift.

What to include:

- A summary of what happened during the shift in the order it occurred.
- Each task or activity and the level of support provided (independent, verbal prompt, physical assist, full support).
- Duration of activities where relevant.
- Any deviations from the usual routine and the reason.

4.3 Client Wellbeing

Record an objective observation of the Client's physical and emotional presentation during the shift.

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What to include:

- *Mood and emotional state (use observable descriptions — e.g. "appeared calm", "was tearful at the start of the shift").*
- *Physical health observations — any changes in appearance, mobility, pain, skin condition, etc.*
- *Appetite and fluid intake (if part of the care plan or if there is a change to note).*
- *Sleep (if a sleepover or if the client mentions it).*
- *Personal hygiene and grooming completed during the shift.*
- *Any change from the client's usual presentation that the next worker or supervisor should be aware of.*

4.4 Community Access and Activities

If the shift included any activity outside the home or community participation, record the following.

What to include:

- *The location(s) visited and purpose of the outing.*
- *Duration of the outing.*
- *Client's participation and engagement.*
- *Transport used (own vehicle, public transport, client's vehicle).*
- *If using own vehicle, ensure a Mileage Claim is submitted — see Section 4.7.*

4.5 Medication

If medication administration is within your scope of practice and a part of the Client's plan, you must record the following every time.

What to include:

- *Name of medication administered.*
- *Dosage and route of administration.*
- *Time administered.*
- *Client's response or any observations following administration.*
- *Whether the client refused medication (record their words if possible).*
- *Your name as the administering worker.*

Important:

Workers must only administer medication within their approved scope of practice and as authorised by the Client's Support Plan.

If in doubt, contact your supervisor before administering any medication.

4.6 Handover

The handover section ensures continuity of support between shifts. Write anything the next support worker or management needs to know.

What to include:

- *Any tasks that were not completed and why.*
- *Any follow-up actions required (e.g. appointment to book, item to purchase, family member to contact).*
- *Any changes in the client's condition, mood or routine that the next worker should be aware of.*
- *Any communication with family, a guardian or other service providers that occurred during the shift.*
- *Any items running low (e.g. medication, household supplies) if relevant to the care plan.*

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4.7 Mileage

If you used your personal vehicle for work-related travel during the shift, you must submit a Mileage Claim through ShiftCare. Refer to the Staff Compliance and Administrative Obligations Policy for full requirements. Your Shift Note should also record:

What to include:

- That travel occurred and the purpose (e.g. "transport to medical appointment").
- Origin and destination.
- Approximate kilometres.
- That a Mileage Claim has been submitted.

5. Incidents, Accidents and Reportable Events

5.1 When to Record an Incident

Any of the following events during a shift must be documented in full in the Shift Note AND must be reported by completing a separate Incident Report in ShiftCare immediately:

- any accident, injury or near miss involving the Client or the Worker;
- any fall by the Client, regardless of whether injury occurred;
- any behaviour of concern or aggressive behaviour;
- any allegation, disclosure or suspicion of abuse, neglect or exploitation;
- any use of an unauthorised restrictive practice;
- any unexpected change in the Client's medical condition;
- any emergency requiring the attendance of police, ambulance or other emergency services;
- any property damage; and
- any event that the Worker believes should be brought to management's attention.

5.2 How to Document an Incident in Your Shift Note

What to include:

- The exact time the incident occurred.
- A factual description of what happened (what you saw, heard, or did — not your interpretation).
- Who was present.
- The client's response and any immediate actions taken.
- Who you notified and when (e.g. supervisor contacted at 3:45pm).
- Whether an Incident Report has been submitted (state: "Incident Report submitted in ShiftCare at [time]").

Important:

An incident documented only in the Shift Note and not reported separately does not satisfy NDIS reporting obligations.

Contact your supervisor immediately if you are unsure whether an event needs to be reported.

Certain events are Reportable Incidents under the NDIS Act and must be reported to the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission. Your supervisor will advise you.

6. Common Mistakes to Avoid

6.1 Do Not

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- (a) leave the Shift Note blank or enter only a few words — this does not meet NDIS standards;
- (b) copy and paste the same note from a previous shift (even if the shift was similar, the note must reflect what actually happened);
- (c) include your personal opinion of the Client, their family, or other workers;
- (d) use abbreviations or jargon that another reader may not understand;
- (e) include information about other clients in a Client's Shift Note;
- (f) edit or delete a submitted Shift Note without notifying your supervisor — contact management if a correction is needed; or
- (g) complete a Shift Note for a shift you did not personally work.

6.2 Completing a Correction

If you realise after submitting a Shift Note that information is missing or incorrect, contact your supervisor immediately. Do not delete the original note. A correction must be made transparently, noting that it is an amendment, the reason for the amendment, and the date and time of the amendment.

7. Policy Details

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